

expected to reduce fees for royalty-free production music. Several AI companies, such as Mubert, Escrett, and Evoke Music, have already entered this market and specifically target low-budget markets, including indie video game and app developers, as well as YouTubers requiring affordable background music. Additionally, companies like Scored and MatchTune (which recently partnered with production library BMG) use AI to automatically adjust the music to match what is happening on-screen. MatchTune may also benefit from BMG's library of 15,000 tracks, potentially enhancing the quality of its own AI-generated output.

The primary impact of AI on music libraries has been in improving their functionality. Unlike traditional libraries that rely on human-generated tags, AI can quickly fill in track metadata. Additionally, with access to a vast dataset, AI can analyze each track objectively, leading to more accurate results and better search outcomes. This functionality has been especially useful for low-budget markets, such as indie video games and app developers, who need access to royalty-free music quickly and cheaply. Amadeus Code CEO Taishi Fukuyama believes that AI will continue to learn and adapt to user preferences, recommending music that matches specific keywords or themes. For example, an AI program might suggest music for a YouTube channel about sports, camaraderie, leadership, and competition, based on the keywords provided.

What about copyright?

The increasing use of AI in music licensing brings to the fore some complicated issues surrounding intellectual property rights and creative ownership. One of the primary concerns is that training an AI to create music requires



feeding it with a vast amount of pre-existing music, which entails copying numerous songs so that the program can analyze and learn from them. Although this copying is generally regarded as “fair use” in countries like the USA, Japan, and China, it is necessary to obtain permission from rightsholders for commercial purposes in Europe, where they have the option of opting out from such usage.